

# You Have Reached Your Destination!



Having a GPS device has its own benefits, while exploring the road less travelled. We test some of the best ones here this month.

Vishal Mathur

[vishal.mathur@thinkdigit.com](mailto:vishal.mathur@thinkdigit.com)

Since we last tested GPS navigators over a year ago, a lot of water has flowed under the bridge, and we're happy to report that these navigation devices have improved quite a lot in many aspects – the quality of the package and the device itself, navigation quality, feature set and ease of use. The depth and quality of coverage has improved immensely as well, with POIs being added all the time, making these devices all the more worthwhile.

For those of us who don't have a GPS device installed in our vehicles, the common prac-

tice of rolling down the window and asking someone in the adjacent vehicle for directions is quite normal. However, doing it one time too many can be irritating – plus, imagine stopping and starting your car at every street crossing or signal – and lengthen your time on the road unnecessarily.

## Firewalled: The safety aspect

Then there's also the safety issue to consider. A GPS and navigation device can come in handy if you're lost in an unknown part of town late at night, trying to find your way back – not the best time to reveal to a stranger that you're lost, is it? This is where, a simple GPS device in

the car will be a no-nonsense guide that corrects your course back to the road leading to your ultimate destination.

## It's a guide, not a command

Ideally, these devices are meant for use as a guide, and they shouldn't interrupt you while driving, which is the most important thing. And their guidance isn't something etched in stone, and neither will you get rapped on your knuckles for not following the direction spelt out by the navigation device to the last letter. Yes, the quality of mapping has improved considerably over the last 12 months, something that we have experienced since our previous GPS

comparison test in the summer of 2012. But, there is always the chance of a mapping error, or a change in the topography that the map may not yet reflect. As a rule, only listen to the navigators' directions while driving, and only look at the device's digital display when your vehicle is stationary by the curb or at a traffic signal.

With that being said, let's deep dive into our analysis of this year's GPS and personal navigation devices.

## First Touch: Comparing the build quality

Let us start off with the most inexpensive navigator in this comparison, the SatGuide 4.3